

MB&F x L'Epee Starfleet Explorer

The two Swiss brands, MB&F and L'Epee, have collaborated in the past to create some unique stuff, including the Sherman robo-watch and the Octopod table clock. They've now come together to create the Starfleet Explorer, a desk clock that's, well, out of this world. The Starfleet Explorer isn't very big measuring in at 16.5cm x 11cm, but it's definitely eye-catching. The timepiece features three small spacecraft in orbit around it that rotate every five minutes.



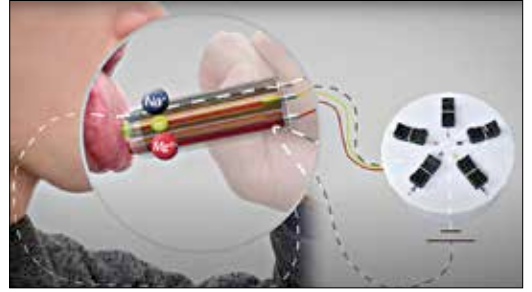
Coming to the clock itself, towards the top of the clock is the disc on which the minutes are marked at five-minute intervals. The disc itself rotates every 60 minutes, and the time is indicated through a fixed hand. Under the disc is the conical chapter ring that has the hours. Instead of the ring rotating, this time, it's another hand, similar to the fixed one that showcases minutes, that rotates around the ring to show the correct hour time. This hand rotates around the ring every 12 hours.

The table clock is powered by hand-wound movement and operates at 18,000 vibrations per hour. It has reserves for up to 8 days and is wound with a double-ended key, which is also used to set the time. The entire watch is held off the ground via three steel arcs.

Norimaki Synthesizer

Licking your gadgets isn't something we usually condone. Well, unless you're Meiji University researcher Homei Miyashita, in which case go right ahead. We mean, if you've managed to create a device that can artificially recreate flavours, by all means.

We initially used to believe that the tongue had different areas where taste buds were concentrated for different types of tastes such as sweet, salty, bitter etc. We now know that is false and that our buds are distributed pretty evenly across our tongue. This new prototype, the Norimaki Synthesizer, could be key to better understanding how the tongue works.



The design for this project was actually inspired by the eyes. Miyashita saw how easy it was to trick our eyes into seeing things that technically aren't there. When staring at a display or screen, for example, it's technically a lot of tiny pixels made up of RGB (red, blue and green) that combine to create the images that you're seeing. The same principle applies to the Norimaki Synthesizer, which basically tricks the tongue into tasting.

There are colour coded gels, each in long tubes that create different tastes using different chemicals. By mixing tastes and intensities together specific flavours can be created.

MaeGo

We've seen toy RC cars and AI cars, but we haven't yet seen one that's been designed for target practice! The creators of MaeGo claim theirs is the world's first AI robot car that can autonomously play FPS games with you. This is of course in addition to all the tasks you'd otherwise expect from an AI car. The car comes with toy guns that can shoot infrared rays, and the FPS mode also works with other toy guns such as those from Nerf that fire foam balls or darts.

The MaeGo doubles as a coding platform as well, ideal for kids to get into coding. MaeGo works with block-based programming app Blockly for some very user friendly programming, allowing for coding of movement, audio and its LEDs. The MaeGo



also supports Python programming, allowing even more advanced coders to play around with the car. Some of the actions that the car can be programmed to perform include making the car stand on its front wheel and even spin around. Object recognition and tracking can also be programmed into the car.